

Entity-Level Framing Annotation Guide

Reference Guide for Manual Annotation and Web-Based Entity-Level Framing Analysis

1. Task Overview

Assign ONE framing label to the target entity based on how it is portrayed within the sentence.

Focus On	Do NOT Use
- Entity role - Actions & relationships - Sentence-level context	- Sentiment polarity - Outside knowledge - Personal interpretation

2. Framing Labels

Label	Definition	Example
Legitimate	Acting lawfully or asserting rights	"The Philippines stated that its actions comply with international law." → Philippines = Legitimate
Aggressor	Provoking conflict or violating rules	"Chinese coast guard ships used water cannons against Philippine vessels." → Chinese coast guard = Aggressor
Defensive	Responding to another actor	"The Philippine Coast Guard deployed patrol ships in response to the incident." → Philippine Coast Guard = Defensive
Neutral	Purely descriptive, no clear role	"Officials from both countries attended the regional summit." → Officials = Neutral

3. Decision Guide

Step	Question	Label
1	Violating norms or escalating conflict?	Aggressor
2	Acting lawfully or asserting rights?	Legitimate
3	Responding to another action?	Defensive
4	None or unclear?	Neutral

4. Rules

• Use only the sentence • One label per entity • Choose dominant role • If unclear → Neutral

5. Additional Examples

Sentence	Entity	Label
China deployed additional military vessels near the shoal.	China	Aggressor
The Philippines filed a diplomatic protest after the incident.	Philippines	Defensive
Officials from ASEAN member states met to discuss maritime security.	Officials	Neutral
The government stated that the patrol operation followed international law.	Government	Legitimate

Key Reminder: Framing may be implied through wording, attribution, and narrative structure—not emotional sentiment.